

YOGA MANDALA

Portal & Community Framework — V1

Learn. Connect. Collaborate. Serve.

Purpose: A practical product blueprint that can be handed to a designer, developer or AI web-building system to create the Yoga Mandala portal.

Core principle: The portal is the digital home of the community — not merely a website for the WhatsApp group.

1. Executive Definition

Yoga Mandala is a community and learning ecosystem for Yoga teachers and serious practitioners. Its purpose is to strengthen the Yoga teaching community through continuous learning, meaningful connection, responsible sharing and collaboration.

WhatsApp can remain the conversation and announcement layer. The portal should become the structured, searchable and permanent home for people, knowledge, opportunities and events.

Pillar	Meaning
LEARN	Structured learning, resources, study and teacher development.
CONNECT	Find fellow teachers, practitioners, experts and community members.
COLLABORATE	Share opportunities, spaces, projects, referrals and professional/community needs.
SERVE	Contribute knowledge, volunteer, mentor and strengthen the wider Yoga ecosystem.

2. Identity, Boundaries & Relationship with Pranava

Yoga Mandala IS

- A community-led network for Yoga teachers and serious practitioners.
- A learning ecosystem and knowledge-sharing space.
- A platform for teacher-to-teacher connection and collaboration.
- A curated discovery space for relevant Yoga education, events and resources.
- A home for meetups, study circles, expert conversations and community initiatives.

Yoga Mandala is NOT

- A personal-brand website.
- A disguised advertising channel for one organisation.
- A generic social-media clone.
- A place for unrestricted promotional posting.
- A repository for unauthorised copyrighted material.

Pranava and Yoga Mandala

Pranava may contribute, organise initiatives and submit offerings, but Yoga Mandala must retain an independent community identity. Pranava programmes should be clearly labelled as Pranava offerings unless formally organised by Yoga Mandala. The same principle should apply to every other organisation.

This distinction protects neutrality, trust and long-term credibility.

3. Community Architecture

Layer	Purpose	Examples
Community	People and relationships	Teacher Directory, Sangha, meetups, experts
Learning	Knowledge and development	Learning Initiatives, Library, Reading Circle, Teacher's Desk
Discovery	Opportunities and offerings	Learning Bulletin, events, spaces, collaborations

WhatsApp vs Portal

WhatsApp	Portal
Fast conversation	Permanent information home
Announcements/reminders	Searchable directory
Informal discussion	Curated knowledge/resources
Immediate interaction	Submissions + moderation workflow
Drives traffic	Preserves community knowledge

4. Information Architecture

Main section	Core pages
Home	Mission, pillars, featured content, upcoming events, join CTA
Learn	Learning Initiatives, Library, Reading Circle, Teacher's Desk
Connect	Teacher Directory, Experts, Sangha
Collaborate	Sangha Board, opportunities, spaces, projects
Events	Meetups, study circles, workshops, online events
Discover	Curation & Learning Bulletin, Community Listings
About	Mission, principles, governance, contact
Join / Submit	Join, profile, event, learning, resource and listing submissions

Recommended V1 navigation: Home | Learn | Connect | Collaborate | Events | Discover | About | Join / Submit

5. Homepage Specification

Hero:

YOGA MANDALA

Learn. Connect. Collaborate. Serve.

A community of Yoga teachers and serious practitioners building a culture of continuous learning, meaningful collaboration and responsible teaching.

Homepage sections

1. Hero + Join the Sangha.
2. Four pillars: Learn / Connect / Collaborate / Serve.
3. Featured Yoga Mandala Learning Initiative.
4. Upcoming community event or meetup.
5. Featured teacher/contributor.
6. Latest curated learning opportunities.
7. Featured library/resource.
8. Invitation: Share something with the Sangha.
9. Footer with community links, governance/contact and submission links.

Visual direction: calm, scholarly, warm, contemporary, Indian without becoming decorative or stereotypical. Avoid aggressive sales language and generic wellness-marketplace aesthetics.

6. LEARN — Learning Ecosystem

6.1 Yoga Mandala Learning Initiative

For programmes, sessions, study circles, lectures, mentorships or educational projects formally organised or endorsed by Yoga Mandala.

Field	Required information
Title	Name of initiative
Type	Workshop / study circle / lecture / series / mentorship / other
Facilitator	Name + short profile
Schedule	Date, time and timezone
Format	Online / offline / hybrid
Fee	Free / paid / contribution
Audience	Beginner / teacher / experienced teacher / open
Description	What participants will learn

Registration	Portal or external registration
Badge	Yoga Mandala Learning Initiative

6.2 Yoga Mandala Curation & Learning Bulletin

For relevant external programmes, workshops, retreats, teacher trainings, books, research and events submitted by members or discovered by the curation team. These are NOT automatically Yoga Mandala programmes.

Use a clear label such as 'Curated Community Listing' or 'External Offering'.

6.3 Library

- Yoga philosophy
- Texts and commentaries
- Asana and methodology
- Anatomy and biomechanics
- Pranayama
- Meditation
- Ayurveda
- Sanskrit
- Yoga history and culture
- Research
- Teaching methodology

Resource metadata: title, author, subject, context/tradition, short description, recommended level, source/rights information and access method.

Copyright principle: do not upload or redistribute protected books, recordings or documents without permission. Where rights are unclear, use legitimate links, bibliographic information or approved access methods.

6.4 Reading Circle

Selected text + reading period + facilitator + discussion prompts + meeting date + community reflections.

7. CONNECT — People & Sangha

7.1 Teacher Directory

The directory should become one of Yoga Mandala's core long-term assets.

Profile field	Notes
Name	Public name
Photo	Optional
Location	City / region
Experience	Years or concise description
Tradition / approach	Self-described
Qualifications	Relevant training/certifications
Areas of interest	Asana, philosophy, therapy, prenatal, children, etc.
Languages	Languages taught

Teaching format	Online / offline / both
Bio	100–150 words
Links	Website / professional social profile
Contact	Prefer enquiry form rather than public private details

Directory filters

- City / region
- Tradition / approach
- Area of teaching
- Experience
- Online / offline
- Language
- Teacher / therapist / researcher / other role

7.2 Expert Network

A curated list of experienced members willing to contribute to Q&A, study circles, expert conversations or mentoring. Verification must be transparent and must not imply blanket endorsement.

8. COLLABORATE — Sangha Board

The Sangha Board allows opportunities that would otherwise disappear inside group chats to become searchable and useful.

Category	Purpose
Looking for	Seeking teacher, collaborator or expertise
Offering	Offering teaching, mentoring, resources or skills
Space	Studio / community / retreat space available
Project	Seeking collaborators
Volunteer	Community service opportunity
Referral	Useful professional/community referral
Teacher exchange	Class, workshop or knowledge exchange

Every listing should have: title, category, description, location/online, poster, contact method and expiry date.

9. EVENTS

- Yoga Mandala Sangha Meetups
- Learning Initiatives
- Study Circles
- Expert Conversations
- Community Workshops
- Reading Circles
- Partner / external events

Event card: Title • Date • Time • Location/Online • Host • Audience • Free/Paid • Description • Registration • Category/badge.

Future option: optional attendee check-in/registration, without turning the community into an engagement-metrics platform.

10. DISCOVER — Curation & Community Listings

Curation workflow

10. Member submits listing.
11. Submission enters moderation queue.
12. Admin/curator checks relevance, accuracy, presentation and community fit.
13. Approved listing receives the correct category and badge.
14. Listing is published with an expiry/review date.
15. Approved items may be summarised in WhatsApp.
16. Expired items are archived.

Badge	Meaning
Yoga Mandala Learning Initiative	Formally organised/endorsed by Yoga Mandala
Curated Community Listing	External opportunity selected for relevance
Community Listing	Member-submitted listing meeting community rules
Partner / Guest	Legitimate external collaborator or organisation

Unsolicited self-promotion, repeated advertising, referral spam, unrelated commercial posts and promotional content outside the submission process should not be published.

11. TEACHER'S DESK — Knowledge & Discussion

A structured alternative to allowing valuable teacher discussions to disappear in WhatsApp.

- Teaching methodology
- Asana and sequencing
- Anatomy / biomechanics
- Yoga therapy
- Pranayama
- Philosophy / texts
- Ayurveda
- Teaching ethics
- Student management
- Professional development
- Career / community building

Ask the Sangha

Members submit questions; qualified members respond. Valuable discussions can later be curated into knowledge-base articles after review.

Distinguish personal experience, professional opinion, traditional interpretation and evidence-supported information. Therapeutic/medical claims require appropriate care and should not be presented as diagnosis or medical advice.

12. Membership & Roles

Role	Permissions
Visitor	Browse public information, events and selected listings
Member	Profile, participation, submissions and event registration
Verified Teacher	Teacher directory profile after verification
Contributor	Approved articles/resources/learning content
Curator / Moderator	Review submissions and moderate community content
Administrator	Full community/platform administration
Technical Administrator	Technical maintenance; does not automatically have governance authority

Verification should have published criteria. 'Verified Teacher' means the submitted information has been reviewed against those criteria; it should not imply blanket endorsement.

13. Submission System

Form	Purpose
Join the Sangha	Membership/basic profile
Create Teacher Profile	Directory
Submit an Event	Event calendar
Submit Learning Opportunity	Learning Bulletin / Initiative review
Submit Community Listing	Sangha Board / discovery
Submit Resource	Library curation
Ask the Sangha	Teacher's Desk
Suggest Meetup / Initiative	Community participation

Common fields: name/email, member status, submission type, title, description, links, location/online, date/expiry, accuracy declaration, publication consent and moderator notes.

14. Moderation & Community Guidelines

- Respect Yoga's diversity of traditions while allowing thoughtful disagreement.
- No harassment, personal attacks or targeted hostility.
- No spam or repeated unsolicited promotion.

- No misleading claims about qualifications, outcomes or therapeutic benefits.
- No impersonation or unnecessary personal information.
- No copyright infringement or unauthorised distribution.
- Commercial offerings use the appropriate submission/listing route.
- Moderators act consistently and document significant decisions.

Status	Action
Draft	Not submitted
Submitted	Waiting for review
Under Review	Moderator assessing
Approved	Ready to publish
Changes Requested	Returned to contributor
Published	Live
Expired / Archived	No longer active
Rejected	Not suitable for publication

15. Governance & Ownership

Yoga Mandala should be community-led rather than developer-led. A technical contributor builds and maintains the platform; that does not automatically confer control over community policy.

- Domain under a Yoga Mandala-controlled account.
- Hosting under a Yoga Mandala-controlled account.
- Database and member data remain under Yoga Mandala control.
- Source code in a repository accessible to authorised Yoga Mandala administrators.
- Role-based admin access with at least two trusted continuity administrators.
- Privacy, terms and community guidelines published before collecting substantial member data.

The builder can be acknowledged as a founding technology contributor/partner if desired, but should not personally own the domain, database, brand or community identity.

16. Privacy & Data Principles

- Collect only information with a clear purpose.
- Do not publicly expose private phone numbers or emails by default.
- Give members control over public profile fields.
- Provide profile editing and deletion mechanisms.
- Do not publish sensitive personal information.
- Use secure authentication and role-based permissions.
- Back up the database and document recovery.
- Document who can access member data.

17. Visual & UX Direction

Desired feeling

- Calm
- Scholarly
- Human
- Warm
- Indian without stereotypical decoration
- Contemporary but not corporate
- Trustworthy
- Community-led

Avoid

- Aggressive sales language
- Course-marketplace aesthetics
- Too many banners/pop-ups
- Excessive animation
- Spiritual clichés
- Generic wellness stock imagery
- Gamification for shallow engagement

UX priorities

17. Mobile-first
18. Fast loading
19. Clear navigation
20. Search/filter where useful
21. Accessible typography and contrast
22. Minimal clicks for common actions

18. Technical Requirements

Feature	V1 priority
Responsive website	Must
CMS/admin panel	Must
Member registration/login	Must
Teacher profiles	Must
Directory search/filter	Must
Event listings	Must
Learning Bulletin	Must
Submission forms	Must
Moderation queue	Must
Role permissions	Must
Secure database + backups	Must
SEO basics	Must
Analytics	Should
Email notifications	Should
WhatsApp sharing	Should

Do not overbuild V1

- No complex social feed
- No custom chat system
- No gamification
- No complex payment engine without a clear use case
- No AI chatbot as the centre of the product
- No large custom app before workflows are tested

AI can assist with coding, tagging, search, summaries and admin workflows. Human moderators retain final authority.

19. Data Model

Entity	Core fields
Member	ID, name, email, role, status, location, joined date, privacy
Teacher Profile	Member ID, bio, qualifications, tradition, expertise, languages, links, verification
Event	Title, host, category, date, time, location, description, registration, status
Learning Initiative	Title, facilitator, format, schedule, audience, fee, registration, status
Bulletin Listing	Title, submitter, category, source, description, expiry, approval
Resource	Title, author, category, description, rights/source, access
Sangha Board Post	Title, category, author, location, description, expiry, status
Question	Title, category, author, question, answers, moderation
Submission	Type, submitter, content, status, moderator notes, timestamps

20. Admin Dashboard

- New member requests
- Teacher profiles awaiting verification
- Event submissions
- Learning/Bulletin submissions
- Resource submissions
- Sangha Board posts
- Questions needing moderation
- Reports/flags
- Upcoming events
- Expiring listings

- Basic community health indicators

21. Development Roadmap

Phase	Build
0 — Foundation	Brand, governance, content rules, ownership, privacy, sitemap
1 — MVP	Home, About, Learn, Events, Directory, submissions, admin moderation
2 — Community	Sangha Board, Teacher's Desk, experts, reading circle
3 — Knowledge	Curated knowledge base and deeper library
4 — Ecosystem	Advanced profiles, collaboration tools, dashboards, optional payments

V1 success criteria

- A teacher understands Yoga Mandala within 30 seconds.
- A teacher can find another relevant teacher quickly.
- A member can submit an event or offering without admin intervention.
- An admin can approve/reject submissions easily.
- Initiatives and external offerings are clearly distinguishable.
- WhatsApp can point members to the portal rather than remaining the only information store.

22. Launch Content

- About Yoga Mandala
- Community principles
- Community guidelines
- Privacy policy
- Participation/terms policy
- Teacher Directory introduction
- How to submit an event
- How to submit a learning opportunity
- Learning Initiative page
- Curation & Learning Bulletin page
- Library introduction
- Sangha Board introduction
- Contact/moderation contact

Launch with a small number of high-quality entries rather than dozens of empty sections.

23. COPY-PASTE MASTER PROMPT FOR THE AI BUILDER

Give the AI builder this document plus the prompt below. The AI should first produce an architecture/specification for approval before generating the complete website.

You are the product architect, UX designer and senior full-stack developer for Yoga Mandala.

Use the attached Yoga Mandala Portal & Community Framework as the authoritative product brief.

PRODUCT:

Yoga Mandala is a community and learning ecosystem for Yoga teachers and serious practitioners.
Core promise: Learn. Connect. Collaborate. Serve.

Do NOT turn it into a generic course marketplace, social-media clone or personal-brand website.

V1 NAVIGATION:

Home | Learn | Connect | Collaborate | Events | Discover | About | Join / Submit

V1 MUST INCLUDE:

- Public homepage
- Member registration/login
- Teacher directory with search/filter
- Teacher profiles
- Event listings
- Yoga Mandala Learning Initiatives
- Yoga Mandala Curation & Learning Bulletin
- Submission forms
- Admin moderation queue
- Role-based permissions
- Privacy controls
- Responsive/mobile-first UX
- Secure database and backups
- SEO-friendly public pages

CRITICAL CONTENT DISTINCTION:

A "Yoga Mandala Learning Initiative" is formally organised or endorsed by Yoga Mandala.

A "Curated Community Listing" or "External Offering" is an external opportunity selected for relevance.

Never blur these categories.

Pranava and other organisations may be listed as independent contributors/providers; Yoga Mandala retains an independent identity.

DESIGN:

Calm, scholarly, warm, contemporary, human and community-led.

Avoid aggressive sales pages, clutter, excessive animation, generic wellness stock aesthetics and spiritual clichés.

ADMIN:

Support member management, teacher verification, event approval, listing approval, resource approval, moderation, expiry/archive and role management.

WORKFLOW:

Draft → Submitted → Under Review → Approved / Changes Requested / Rejected → Published → Expired/Archived.

DATA ENTITIES:

Member, Teacher Profile, Event, Learning Initiative, Bulletin Listing, Resource, Sangha Board Post, Question, Submission.

SECURITY:

Use server-side authorization, input validation/sanitisation, secure authentication and database backups. Do not expose private member contact information by default.

AI DEVELOPMENT RULE:

AI may assist with code, search, tagging, summaries and administrative workflows. Human community administrators retain final authority over moderation, verification and factual/credential claims.

BEFORE CODING:

First output:

1. Sitemap
2. User journeys
3. Database schema
4. Role/permission matrix
5. Component architecture
6. Page-by-page wireframe/content structure
7. V1 development plan
8. Hosting/deployment recommendation
9. Security/privacy checklist

Then build the MVP modularly.

Do not add major product features outside the framework without clearly marking them as future-phase suggestions.

24. Handover Checklist

23. Read and accept the framework as the V1 product brief.
24. Confirm sitemap and scope.
25. Confirm ownership of domain, hosting, repository and database.
26. Create the data model before large-scale UI work.

27. Set up staging before public launch.
28. Implement roles and permissions before member registration.
29. Implement moderation before public submissions.
30. Build the Initiative vs External Offering distinction into the data model.
31. Make the site mobile-first.
32. Test every form and permission state.
33. Set up backups and recovery.
34. Provide Yoga Mandala administrators with credentials and documentation.
35. Document how another developer can maintain the platform.

25. Final Product Principle

The long-term asset is not the website itself. It is the network of teachers, the quality of learning, the relationships formed, the knowledge curated and the culture created.

Technology should make those things easier to discover, preserve and participate in.

Build the simplest useful version first. Let the community reveal what needs to exist next.

APPENDIX A — V1 Sitemap

Home

└─ About Yoga Mandala

└─ Community Principles

└─ Learn

| └─ Yoga Mandala Learning Initiatives

| └─ Curation & Learning Bulletin

| └─ Library

| └─ Reading Circle

└─ Connect

| └─ Teacher Directory

| └─ Experts

| └─ Sangha

└─ Collaborate

| └─ Sangha Board

└─ Events

└─ Discover

| └─ Community Listings

└─ Teacher's Desk

| └─ Ask the Sangha

| └─ Knowledge Base (future)

└─ Join the Sangha

└─ Submit

└─ Event

└─ Learning Opportunity

└─ Resource

└─ Community Listing

└─ Question

APPENDIX B — Questions for the First Build Meeting

36. What is the smallest V1 that genuinely helps the community?
37. Which information should be public and which should require membership?
38. What qualifies someone as a Verified Teacher?
39. Who are the first moderators/curators?
40. Which submissions require approval?
41. How are moderation disputes handled?
42. Who owns and controls the technical infrastructure?
43. What launch content is already available?
44. What should remain on WhatsApp rather than move to the portal?
45. What should be reviewed after the first 90 days?